

OFFSPRING TYPEFACE ALTERNATIVES

TREESONGS / RIVERSPRINGS / WHISPERLAKE

Three display alternatives for each offspring name treatment, with the reasoning behind each one. The parent system is unchanged: layout, grids, endorsement and the Optima and Pelago supporting typography stay exactly as specified in the master guidelines. Only the name artwork is in question here.

TIGONI, KENYA / 2026

TREESONGS

CINZEL

Riversprings

ALLURA

whisperlake

CORMORANT LIGHT

SELECTION

— HOW THESE ALTERNATIVES WERE CHOSEN

02

Each offspring already has an approved name treatment and a defined character. The alternatives below are not a redesign — they are three credible ways of expressing the same brief, offered so the choice can be made against real specimens rather than description. Every candidate was tested against the same five requirements.

THE FIVE TESTS

01 REFERENCE

It has to sit beside Optima without competing with it. The name treatment is the only voice that changes between projects; everything around it is fixed, so a face that fights the supporting typography breaks the family.

02 THE NAME BAR

Every candidate was set reversed out of the offspring's core colour at roughly 11 pt, the size it runs in the endorsement lockup. Faces that fill in or thin out at that size are marked with a minimum-size rule.

03 TRACKING

Treesongs and Whisperlake are both specified with generous tracking. A face has to open up without the word falling into loose letters — that rules out anything with strong horizontal connection or tight fitting.

04 RANGE OF SCALE

The same artwork has to work carved into signage and rendered as a favicon. Candidates were proofed at 96 pt and at 9 pt; the notes say plainly where a face is only safe at one end.

05 LICENCE

All nine candidates are SIL Open Font Licence 1.1 — free for desktop, web, application and signage use, with no seat count and no annual renewal. Licensing is covered on page 07.

WHAT IS NOT CHANGING

THE SUPPORTING TYPOGRAPHY

Optima and Pelago continue to set every heading, sub-heading, caption and paragraph across all three offspring. None of the candidates here is proposed for body text.

THE COLOUR PALETTES

The five-step palettes issued in the guideline amendment are unaffected. Each specimen on the following pages is shown in its own family's core colour.

ONE FACE PER OFFSPRING

The chosen face is reserved for the project name. It does not spread into headlines, pull quotes or captions — that is what keeps the name treatment doing any work at all.

THE NINE CANDIDATES

TREESONGS

TREESONGS

Cinzel

TREESONGS

Cormorant Garamond

TREESONGS

Spectral

RIVERSPRINGS

Riversprings

Allura

Riversprings

Petit Formal Script

Riversprings

Dancing Script

WHISPERLAKE

whisperlake

Cormorant Light

whisperlake

Josefin Sans Light

whisperlake

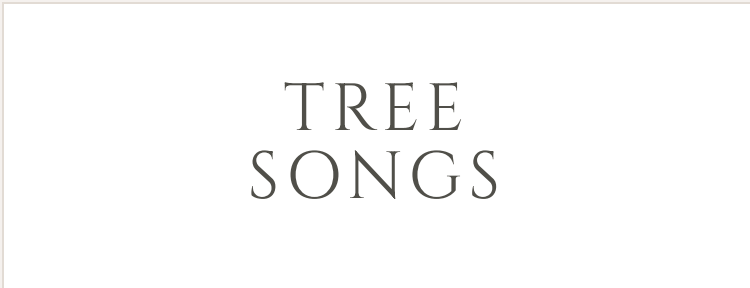
Tenor Sans

TREESONGS — THREE ALTERNATIVES

O3

The brief. Uppercase serif with generous spacing, signalling refinement, permanence and flagship stature. Transformative, cultivated and purposeful — quietly prestigious and comprehensive, never showy.

ALTERNATIVE O1



Cinzel

INSCRIPTIONAL ROMAN CAPITALS · NATANAEL GAMA · OFL 1.1

Why. Cinzel is drawn from first-century Roman inscriptional lettering — the same lineage as words cut into stone. That gives Treesongs permanence and flagship stature without adding a single ornament. Its capitals are wide and evenly weighted, so the generous tracking the brief asks for reads as monumental rather than merely loose.

Trade-off. Effectively an uppercase face — the lowercase is a small-cap. No text weight, so it cannot extend beyond the name.

ALTERNATIVE O2



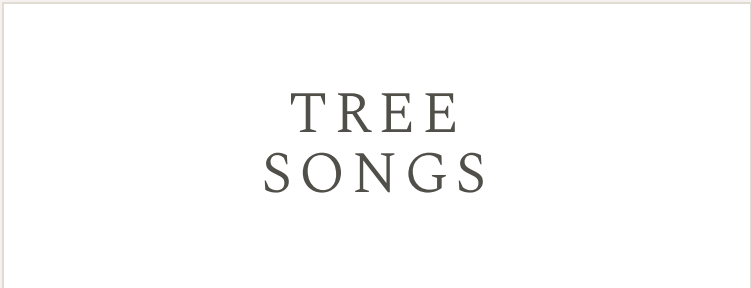
Cormorant Garamond

HIGH-CONTRAST GARAMOND REVIVAL · CHRISTIAN THALMANN · OFL 1.1

Why. The most cultivated of the three. High stroke contrast and very fine hairlines make it read as literary rather than corporate, which is the closest match to "quietly prestigious". The delicate weight sits beautifully on the Lime Wash ground and gives the name a lightness the other two do not have.

Trade-off. Those hairlines disappear when reversed out of Terracotta below about 14 pt. Specify the Medium weight for the name bar and for any fabricated signage.

ALTERNATIVE O3



Spectral

LOW-CONTRAST SCREEN SERIF · PRODUCTION TYPE · OFL 1.1

Why. The working option. Spectral was drawn for screens, so it holds its colour at small sizes, in the name bar and in a browser tab, where both classical candidates need protecting. It is also the most expansive: a full family of weights and italics to grow into as Treesongs produces more material.

Trade-off. Less ceremonial. It reads as a well-made working brand face rather than a flagship mark.

— IN THE NAME BAR, REVERSED OUT OF TERRACOTTA



RIVERSPRINGS — THREE ALTERNATIVES

O4

The brief. A flowing script whose movement expresses freedom, spontaneity and the balance between restoration and energy. Expressive and sociable while remaining polished and grounded. The script stays exclusive to the project name.

ALTERNATIVE O1



Allura
FORMAL CONNECTED SCRIPT · ROBERT LEUSCHKE · OFL 1.1

Why. Long, unbroken connective strokes and a shallow slope, so the word reads as flow rather than flourish. It is the closest in spirit to the current name artwork and therefore the lowest-risk of the three. The generous ascenders give the word a horizon line, which quietly echoes water and landscape without illustrating either.

Trade-off. Fine hairlines. Do not set below 18 pt, and avoid reversing it out of River Green at small sizes.

ALTERNATIVE O2



Petit Formal Script
ENGRAVED UPRIGHT SCRIPT · IMPALLARI TYPE · OFL 1.1

Why. More upright and more engraved than Allura, with the character of a copperplate invitation. This is the option that brings the polished, grounded half of the brief forward — the one to choose if Riversprings needs to sit credibly beside Treesongs on a shared masthead without looking like the informal sibling.

Trade-off. The formality costs spontaneity. The energy in the brief then has to come from imagery and tone rather than the name.

ALTERNATIVE O3



Dancing Script
CASUAL BOUNCING SCRIPT · IMPALLARI TYPE · OFL 1.1

Why. A lively casual script with a deliberately uneven baseline, so the word moves as you read it. It is the most sociable and the most energetic of the three, and by a wide margin the most robust — it survives small sizes, reversed settings and low-resolution screens where both formal scripts have to be protected.

Trade-off. The least ceremonial. There is a real risk it reads as friendly hospitality rather than restorative retreat.

— IN THE NAME BAR, REVERSED OUT OF RIVER GREEN



WHISPERLAKE — THREE ALTERNATIVES

O5

The brief. Lowercase, light weight, generous tracking. Preserve its openness and delicate weight — never embolden, compress or convert it to uppercase. Calming, serene, elegant, soulful and quietly mysterious.

ALTERNATIVE 01

whisper
lake

Cormorant Light

HIGH-CONTRAST DISPLAY SERIF · CHRISTIAN THALMANN · OFL 1.1

Why. Exceptionally fine hairlines and a small x-height mean that, tracked out, the word almost dissolves into the page — which is precisely the quietly mysterious quality the brief asks for. Its lowercase is the most expressive of the three, and it is the only candidate that feels genuinely delicate rather than simply light.

Trade-off. The most fragile option by some distance. Below 16 pt, or reversed out of Mist, it disappears. It needs a stated minimum size.

ALTERNATIVE 02

whisper
lake

Josefin Sans Light

GEOMETRIC SANS, SMALL X-HEIGHT · SANTIAGO OROZCO · OFL 1.1

Why. A geometric sans with a deliberately small x-height and tall ascenders. The wide circular bowls create exactly the open negative space the brief calls for, and it tracks out further than any serif here without the word breaking apart. The calmest silhouette of the three.

Trade-off. Its 1920s geometry carries a period flavour. Read in isolation it can feel vintage rather than timeless.

ALTERNATIVE 03

whisper
lake

Tenor Sans

LOW-CONTRAST HUMANIST SANS · DENIS MASHAROV · OFL 1.1

Why. Quiet, wide and low in contrast — the most legible of the three and the safest across signage, interface and small print. Where Cormorant needs protecting, Tenor Sans simply works. It delivers calm without fragility, which matters given that Mist cannot carry text.

Trade-off. A larger x-height makes it less airy. It is the least mysterious of the three, trading atmosphere for robustness.

— IN THE NAME BAR — DEEP SLATE ON MIST, AS WHITE FAILS CONTRAST

whisperlake

whisperlake

whisperlake

AT A GLANCE

ALL NINE CANDIDATES COMPARED

06

The same nine faces, ranked within each family from the most characterful to the most robust. Read across: as a name gains atmosphere it generally loses resilience at small sizes. Where a project will live mostly on signage and print, take the left column; where it will live mostly on screens, take the right.

OFFSPRING	CANDIDATE	CLASSIFICATION	TRACKING	MINIMUM SIZE	REVERSED OUT	BEST SUITED TO
TREESONGS	Cinzel	Inscriptional Roman caps	+100 to +160	12 pt	SAFE	Signage, covers, stone and metal fabrication
	Cormorant Garamond	High-contrast Garamond	+120 to +180	14 pt	MEDIUM WT ONLY	Print, editorial, invitations
	Spectral	Low-contrast screen serif	+80 to +140	8 pt	SAFE	Digital-first rollout, interface, small print
RIVERSPRINGS	Allura	Formal connected script	0 — never track	18 pt	24 PT AND UP	Covers, hoardings, large-format applications
	Petit Formal Script	Engraved upright script	0 — never track	15 pt	20 PT AND UP	Stationery, shared mastheads, formal collateral
	Dancing Script	Casual bouncing script	0 — never track	11 pt	SAFE	Digital, wayfinding, merchandise, social
WHISPERLAKE	Cormorant Light	High-contrast display serif	+140 to +200	16 pt	NOT ON MIST	Covers, print, large architectural applications
	Josefin Sans Light	Geometric sans	+160 to +220	12 pt	14 PT AND UP	Editorial, environmental graphics, print
	Tenor Sans	Low-contrast humanist sans	+120 to +170	9 pt	SAFE	Interface, wayfinding, small-scale applications

OUR RECOMMENDATION

IF THE THREE BRANDS ARE BEING BUILT OUT TOGETHER

Cinzel · Allura · Cormorant Light — these three give the family the widest spread of character while each staying true to its own brief. They are the strongest set, and they are the set that most needs its minimum-size rules respected.

IF THE FIRST APPLICATIONS ARE DIGITAL

Spectral · Dancing Script · Tenor Sans — noticeably less ceremonial, but all three survive small sizes, reversed settings and screen rendering without special handling. Choose this set if the name will appear more often at 12 pt than at 120 pt.

THE RECOMMENDED SET AT WORKING SIZES

TREESONGS

TREESONGS

TREESONGS

Riversprings

Riversprings

Riversprings

whisperlake

whisperlake

whisperlake

Cinzel at 20 pt, 11 pt and 7 pt. Holds its colour throughout; the 7 pt setting is below the stated 12 pt minimum and shown only to mark the floor.

Allura at 26 pt, 15 pt and 9 pt. The connective strokes begin to break up below 18 pt — the 9 pt setting shows why the minimum is set where it is.

Cormorant Light at 20 pt, 12 pt and 8 pt. The hairlines thin out fastest of the three; treat 16 pt as a hard floor in any application.

LICENSING — AND PRODUCTION NOTES

07

All nine candidates are released under the SIL Open Font Licence 1.1. That was a selection criterion, not a coincidence — it removes per-seat licensing from the offspring brands entirely and lets the designer, the fabricator and the web developer all work from the same files.

WHAT THE LICENCE PERMITS

Unlimited desktop installation, web font serving, embedding in applications and documents, and use in fabricated signage. No seat count, no page-view ceiling, no renewal. The fonts may also be modified — relevant if the name artwork is eventually redrawn from one of these as a starting point.

The one restriction: the font files themselves may not be sold on their own, and any modified version must not use the original reserved font name.

WHAT STAYS COMMERCIALY LICENSED

Optima LT Pro and Pelago remain the parent system's licensed faces and are unaffected by anything in this document. Existing licences must continue to cover every seat setting Craft Union material, and any web use of the supporting typography still needs its own web font licence.

Nothing proposed here reduces or replaces that requirement.

A NOTE ON THIS DOCUMENT

The specimens on pages 03 to 06 are set in the actual candidate fonts and are accurate. The document's own headings and body text are set in open substitutes standing in for Optima and Pelago, because those two are not redistributable. Final artwork must be reset in the licensed faces before anything is released.

The name treatments shown are typeset specimens, not finished artwork — the chosen face still needs drawing out, spacing and optical correction.

— NEXT STEPS

01 — SHORTLIST

Select one candidate per offspring, or one set from the recommendation on page 06.

02 — PROOF AT SCALE

Test the shortlist at true signage size and at favicon size before committing. The minimum-size rules on page 06 are conservative but not arbitrary.

03 — DRAW THE ARTWORK

Convert the chosen setting to outlines, correct the spacing optically, and issue it as locked name artwork.

04 — AMEND THE GUIDELINES

Fold the approved name artwork into the offspring character guidelines, replacing the typography note on each character page.